The 6:15

THURSDAY · NOVEMBER 12, 2026 NO. 40

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Thu 11/12 (today)	Applied Materials fiscal Q4, after close — Street consensus (24 analysts, Investing.com) ~$10.30B revenue ($10.25–10.54B range), $4.06/sh., close to AMAT's own Q3 guide of $10.25B±$500M/$4.02±$0.20. Issue No. 39 carried Cisco as also reporting tonight; that date could not be independently verified this run **[flag, corrects an unverified carryover]**.
Fri 11/13	October PPI, 8:30a ET — one preview calls it the loudest y/y print since 2022 but cites no specific consensus number **[flag, single-sourced, no number confirmed]**. Also the earliest date cited for Anthropic to price its IPO **[flag, single-sourced]**.
Sat 11/14	Northwestern at Ohio State.
Mon 11/16	Earliest cited Nasdaq debut for Anthropic (ANT); one report says it could slip to Wed. 11/18 **[flag, differing single sources]**.
Tue 11/17	David Bednar's deadline to accept/decline the Yankees' $23.15M qualifying offer, 4p ET.
Thu 11/19	Lloyd's List's next Hormuz brief (now fortnightly Thursdays).

No FOMC in this window — Fed holds 3.50%–3.75% through Dec. 9; market-implied odds of a December hike rose this week (see Economics). OPEC+'s Nov. 29 ministerial, which sets the 2027 framework, falls outside the window; Nov./Dec. output has already been held steady for a third straight month.

METRICS

Equities (Tue. close)	S&P 500 7,520.93 (−0.38%, hot CPI); (Wed. close) S&P ~7,619–7,626 (+1.3%–1.4%, outlets vary); Nasdaq Comp. ~25,466–25,583 (+1.6%); Dow +0.5% **[flag, Wed. closes vary by source]**

Oil	Last confirmed settle (Mon.): Brent $92.57, WTI $86.85. No independently confirmed Tue./Wed. settle found; post-market quotes range Brent $91.3–$94.0, WTI $84.4–$87.3 across sources **[flag, unsettled, ~$2.50 spread across sources]**
Rates	10Y 4.99% (Tue. close) → >5.00% (Thu. a.m., CNBC); 2Y ~4.72%–4.74% (Tue. close, sources vary); 30Y ~5.35% (Thu. a.m.)
VIX	~17.49 (Wed. close, −10.1%); one source reports 17.82 **[flag, sources split]**
Gold	~$4,000–$4,007 (Wed. close, Dec. futures/spot), down from Mon.'s $4,138.25
DXY	102.92 (Wed. close, +0.67%), up from Mon.'s 101.73 on rising hike odds
Asia (Thu. close)	Nikkei ~61,714 (+0.8%); Kospi +1.2%; Hang Seng −1.1%; Shanghai not found this run
Europe	DAX 26,642.06 (+1.12%); FTSE 10,835.48 (+0.78%) — likely Wed.'s close; today's session wasn't finished at this issue's press time **[flag, date uncertain]**
Retail gas (AAA)	$4.0203/gal nat'l avg. (11/8), down from $4.1003 (11/5) — 4 days stale, no fresher pull this run

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Mine claim	IRGC says 2 supertankers "disabled" by explosions late Wed. after entering an "unauthorized route" — Iranian state media only, no independent confirmation found **[flag, single-sourced]**
Transits	Nov. 1: Windward 8 vessels (3 dark); a separate independent AIS monitor, 10; IMF PortWatch's last confirmed figure (carried forward), 1 — three vendors, three counts, one day, vs. ~85/day pre-war baseline
Dark tankers	Kpler: ~80% of a recent two-week span moved dark (undated within "recent"); straits.live's last confirmed screen, 86/160 (53.8%), as of Nov. 4 — 8 days stale
Flows	Kpler ~13.1M b/d latest confirmed week vs. 17.1M b/d pre-war (~77%) — unchanged from issue No.

	39, no fresher pull
War-risk premium	ShipUniverse model: +7.5%–10% of hull value, up from 1%–3% weeks earlier **[NEW, modeled, not a market quote]**; the ~32.0x pre-crisis multiplier (Oct. 7) is now 37 days stale, background only

IRGC/Iranian state media, UKMTO, Windward, an independent AIS monitor, IMF PortWatch, Kpler and straits.live measure different things (claimed attacks, advisories, AIS-visible transits, dark-fleet share, flow volumes, modeled insurance cost) on different cadences and are never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	No move; Bednar's $23.15M qualifying-offer decision due Tue. 11/17, 4p ET.
Knicks	Beat Milwaukee 117-85 Tue. at MSG, their 4th straight win — now 6-4.
Northwestern	No move; next game Sat. 11/14 at Ohio State, not yet played.

LEAD

RATES · CPI · NVIDIA

October CPI comes in hot and the 10-year punches through 5% — a furious, CoreWeave-powered rebound in stocks papers over a bond market that keeps getting more hawkish

Tuesday's October CPI landed hotter than expected on both lines: headline CPI rose 0.4% month over month against a 0.3% consensus, and core CPI rose 0.3% for a third straight month against a 0.2% consensus, per the Bureau of Labor Statistics' 8:30 a.m. release. [fact] The BLS again published no 12-month rate — a continuing side effect of the data gap left by last year's shutdown — so every annual inflation comparison cited this fall, including in this brief, is a modeled estimate rather than an official figure. [fact] Fed Governor Christopher Waller had said before the release that a third consecutive 0.3% core print could put a larger, half-point December increase

"on the table," and traders took him at his word: the 10-year Treasury yield jumped 11 basis points to close Tuesday at 4.99%, the 2-year rose roughly 17–18 basis points to about 4.72%–4.74% (sources diverge on the exact print), and futures moved to fully price a December hike with two more seen by next June. [fact, flag on exact 2Y print] Equities read the data as a straightforward negative: the S&P 500 fell 0.38% to 7,520.93, giving back roughly a third of Monday's Hormuz-truce rally in a single session.

Wednesday reversed the mood without reversing the rate move. Bond markets were shut for Veterans Day, but equities traded, and CoreWeave's Tuesday-night earnings beat — $3.66 billion in revenue, up 168% year over year and 3.4% above the $3.54 billion consensus, adjusted operating income of $379 million against $200–260 million guidance, and a raised full-year outlook to $13.0–13.3 billion — gave the AI-infrastructure trade its best hard data point since last week's capex-payback selloff. [fact] The S&P 500 rallied to roughly 7,619–7,626 (+1.3%–1.4%, outlets differ on the exact close) and the Nasdaq Composite gained about 1.6% into the mid-25,000s, led by chipmakers. [fact, flag on exact closes] That happened with the bond market closed and the dollar still climbing — DXY settled Wednesday at 102.92, up sharply from Monday's 101.73 — which is the tell that Wednesday's rally was a single hard data point (CoreWeave's print) layered onto a macro backdrop that kept getting more hawkish underneath it, not a reversal of that backdrop. [read] Nvidia itself did not participate: its board's investigation into CEO Jensen Huang stretched into a second evening of meetings Wednesday after a Wall Street Journal report that directors were weighing his removal, which sent the stock down further intraday; no decision had been confirmed as of this run. [fact; see Technology]

By Thursday morning the rate move had kept going. The 10-year crossed 5.00% for the first time this brief has confirmed, with the 30-year holding near 5.35%, per CNBC's early read, while gold — which should benefit from the same risk-aversion lifting yields — instead fell to roughly $4,000–$4,007 an ounce, down about 3% from Monday's $4,138.25 close, consistent with investors pricing higher real rates rather than panic. [fact] Equity futures were choppy and modestly softer early Thursday, weighed down again by Nvidia: one pre-market snapshot had Nasdaq-100 futures down about 0.96%, S&P 500 futures off roughly 0.37%, and Dow futures up about 0.16% — a split tape, with large-cap industrials diverging from tech even before the open. [fact, flag: a single timestamped snapshot, other reads differ] The mechanism worth tracking: a 10-year above 5% raises the discount rate on every long-duration, capital-intensive bet — AI infrastructure chief among them — at the same moment CoreWeave's print is being cited as proof that the capex cycle still works. Those two forces are now pulling against each other inside the same stocks, and Friday's PPI, plus whatever Nvidia's board ultimately decides, will go a long way toward settling which one wins the week. [read]

Watch: whether Nvidia's board resolves Huang's status before Friday's PPI print adds a second hot read to the week; whether Thursday's early yield move holds into a confirmed close above 5%; and whether Applied Materials' results after tonight's close get read as an AI-capex signal or get swamped entirely by the rate story.

POLITICS

Kansas's governor's race has moved but still isn't called. The Secretary of State's latest count, per KSNT, has Democrat Cindy

Holscher at 551,243 votes to Republican Ty Masterson's 543,599 — a lead of roughly 7,600 votes, or about 0.7% of the nearly 1.1 million cast, wider than the 5,500–6,000-vote margin reported in issue No. 39. **[DEVELOPING]** Both a post-race audit and a closer-race audit are underway; county canvasses must finish before the governor, secretary of state and attorney general meet to certify the result, which by statute falls on the first business day of next month. Masterson has not conceded, saying only that "Kansas law calls for another look"; Holscher and outgoing Gov. Laura Kelly continue to call the race decided. The two audits proceed on separate tracks — a standard post-election audit and a closer-race audit triggered by the sub-1% margin — and several other down-ballot races remain uncalled alongside governor, per the same count. No AP call was found this run. [flag] As before, the House Democratic leadership-vote date remains unconfirmed and isn't being re-flagged absent new information.

ECONOMICS

Beyond the Lead: Friday's October PPI (8:30 a.m. ET) follows CPI by a single day, a compressed gap that is this cycle's side effect of the shutdown-delayed data calendar rather than the usual spacing. One preview flagged it as likely to show the largest year-over-year rise since 2022, but no outlet in this run published a specific consensus number alongside that claim, so treat the comparison as directional only. [flag, single-sourced, no number confirmed] Market-implied odds of a December Fed hike rose over the CPI print and held through Wednesday's equity rebound; a Thursday-morning CNBC note describes the bond market as still "awaiting fresh inflation and housing data" even after CPI, implying PPI and an unidentified housing release are both still live inputs into the Dec. 9 decision.

[fact, flag: the housing release wasn't independently identified this run] Within October's CPI itself, one headline-level summary attributes the upside surprise to shelter costs, consistent with the category's persistent role in this cycle's inflation stickiness, though this run did not turn up the specific shelter sub-index print to confirm the magnitude. [flag, directional only] That Dec. 9 meeting date itself is unchanged and still outside this brief's 10-day window.

BUSINESS

Beyond the Lead: Applied Materials reports fiscal Q4 after tonight's close (see Board for consensus); Yahoo Finance's preview flags January-quarter guidance, gross margins, China exposure and whether AI-infrastructure demand is still supporting the order book as the things to watch. [fact] Issue No. 39 carried Cisco as reporting alongside AMAT tonight; this run could not independently verify that date against Cisco's own investor-relations materials, so treat tonight's Cisco report as not verified this run rather than assume the prior issue's date stands. [flag, corrects an unverified carryover] On CoreWeave, beyond the headline beat in the Lead: GAAP operating income was $207 million against a $709 million net loss that widened from $110 million a year earlier, driven by interest expense that nearly tripled year over year to $846 million and rose from roughly $640 million in Q2 — a debt-service trajectory worth watching given the scale of the capacity buildout; backlog reached roughly $132.5 billion, and the company raised full-year adjusted operating income guidance to $1.275–1.375 billion alongside the $20–21 billion annualized revenue run rate it guided to exiting 2026; adjusted EPS came in at −$0.95 against a −$1.16 estimate, GAAP EPS at −$1.27 against −$1.55 estimated. [fact] One report put the after-hours stock move at roughly +5.7%; that figure is single-sourced

and uncorroborated elsewhere. [flag] On Applied Materials specifically, one source describes a four-straight-quarter beat streak heading into tonight's print; issue No. 39 had separately flagged a single-sourced claim of eight straight beats — the two don't agree, which suggests the streak-length claims themselves aren't well corroborated and neither should be read as confirmed. [flag, conflicting single sources]

TECHNOLOGY

Nvidia's board met for a second straight evening Wednesday to decide CEO Jensen Huang's status, after a Wall Street Journal report that directors are weighing his removal over the affair-and-alleged-foreign-intelligence-contact matter detailed in issue No. 39; reported options span removal, placing Huang on leave, or a formal reprimand, and the board has engaged Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz on the underlying investigation. [fact, CNBC/CNN] No decision had been announced as this issue closed. [fact] Unverified betting-market chatter names Ian Buck and Colette Kress as possible successors; treat that as speculative, not reporting. [flag, single-sourced, speculative] Separately, Anthropic's IPO had an eventful 48 hours: a $70–$80-a-share price range reached bankers by email over the weekend and was retracted hours later as "inaccurate," and the amended S-1/A filed Nov. 2 now shows Q3 revenue of roughly $17.0 billion — up about 1,127% year over year — against a $567 million operating loss, a swing from Q2's $974 million operating profit, driven by $5.0 billion of costlier short-term compute commitments and a $2.0 billion non-cash donation-matching charge. Total compute and infrastructure purchase commitments now run to roughly $895.4 billion through 2045, including deals with Google, Amazon and Microsoft that require payment regardless of usage. [fact, sec-api.io analysis of

the filing] That resolves the dueling, uncorroborated $16.3 billion-revenue-vs.-$80 billion-loss and $2.7 billion-profit figures this brief flagged as irreconcilable in issue No. 38: the S-1/A's $17.0 billion Q3 revenue and $567 million operating loss are the company's own reported numbers, though still unaudited. [fact] The company is reportedly targeting a valuation near $2 trillion; pricing could come as early as Friday, with a Nasdaq debut under "ANT" as early as Monday or as late as Wednesday 11/18, per differing single-sourced reports this brief cannot independently confirm. [flag] Nvidia shares, which closed Monday at $178.67, fell further during Wednesday's session on the board-removal reporting; no confirmed Wednesday closing print was available this run. [fact, flag on Wed. close]

GEOPOLITICS

No standalone development beyond the Lead and Iran & Hormuz sections this issue.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Board: the IRGC's claim that two supertankers were disabled by mine strikes late Wednesday, in what Iran calls an "unauthorized route" in the strait's southern approach, follows the pattern of an October incident this brief has previously noted — vessels reportedly abandoned after fires following mine contact — and rests entirely on Iranian state media's account; no Western agency, insurer or UKMTO advisory independently corroborated it as of this run; UKMTO has separately logged "unknown projectile" strikes on vessels in the strait in multiple unrelated cases this week, which is a distinct category of incident from a mine claim and shouldn't be conflated with it. [flag, single-sourced] Monday's Qatar-brokered proposal — Iran reopening Hormuz and halting tanker attacks for a US blockade lift and $8 billion in released funds — had no confirmed update this run: no Rubio statement, Iranian response or White House readout surfaced beyond what issue No. 39 already reported, so its status is unchanged rather than resolved. [flag — absence of news, not confirmation either way] Transit counts keep diverging by vendor on the same day: Windward counted 8 crossings on Nov. 1 (3 without AIS), a separate independent AIS monitor counted 10, and IMF PortWatch's own last confirmed figure, carried forward, was 1 — a reminder that "the" Hormuz transit number depends entirely on whose AIS feed and whose definition of a crossing is being used. Kpler's dark-fleet estimate (~80% of recent traffic) and straits.live's

narrower screen (53.8% as of Nov. 4) are measuring overlapping but not identical universes of vessels and are not reconciled here, per this brief's standing methodology note.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over. Bednar's QO decision due Tue. 11/17, 4p ET; not yet made.
Knicks	117-85 over Milwaukee Tue. (Brunson 23, Towns 21/16) — 4th straight win, now 6-4.
Northwestern	3-7; at Ohio State Sat. 11/14, not yet played.

Continuity. Corrected this issue: Cisco's Thu. 11/12 earnings date, carried from issue No. 39, could not be independently verified and is now flagged rather than assumed. Updated: Kansas's margin (7,600 votes/0.7%, up from 5,500–6,000). Developed: Anthropic's IPO moved from "filed" to active pricing drama — a retracted price range and new Q3 financials from the S-1/A. Watch for next issue: Nvidia's board decision on Huang; tonight's AMAT print; Friday's PPI; Anthropic's pricing; whether the Hormuz mine-strike claim gets independent confirmation.

Unverified figures are marked in red: Tue./Wed. oil settles; Wednesday's exact equity closes; the VIX close (17.49 vs. 17.82); today's Europe levels (likely Wednesday's session); Cisco's earnings date; the IRGC mine-strike claim; Anthropic's pricing/listing dates; betting-market Nvidia succession chatter. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.